THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **The Problem of Choice (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** To decide for whom to produce	Avoids wasting resources
2	**(b)** 2 uniforms	10/5 = 2
3	**(b)** Competition leads to quality and innovation	Competition
4	**(b)** A car assembly line	Heavy machinery
5	**(a)** shift to machines	Cost of labour affects technique
6	**(c)** Firms follow targets without competition	Weak incentive
7	**(c)** water saving and soil health	Sustainability
8	**(b)** essential spending	Needs
9	**(b)** Less of the other good	Trade-off
10	**(a)** for whom to produce	Target consumers

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Resources are limited (1); More of one good means less of the other (1).	1+1
12	To ensure fair play and safety (1); To provide public goods and infrastructure (1).	1+1
13	Wheat falls from 70 to 40 (1); 30 kg given up (1).	1+1
14	Output follows targets, not demand (1); No competition to improve quality (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Revenue is limited (1); Used on infrastructure and welfare (1); Each project has an opportunity cost (1).	1+1+1
16	20 pots for 10 plates (1); One plate costs 2 pots (1); Using the same resources for plates means fewer pots (1).	1+1+1
17	Advanced technology encourages machines (1); Limited technology means manual work (1); E.g. garment factory automating cutting (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Firms must win customers (1); Quality and price improve (1); Innovation is rewarded (1).	1+1+1
18	Shows maximum possible combinations (1); Shows the trade-off between them (1); Helps pick the best combination (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Sugarcane pays more now but uses much water (1); Millets save water and soil (1); Choices today affect the future (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Cost of capital versus cost of labour (1); Level of technology (1); Nature of the product (1); Laws and regulation (1); Scale of demand (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Resources fixed and fully used (1); Barley rises 0 to 100 as wheat falls 100 to 0 (1); Each step costs more wheat (1); A point beyond the curve is unattainable (1); Choice depends on needs (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	A to B: 10 kg wheat (1); B to C: 20 kg wheat (1); C to D: 30 kg wheat (1); D to E: 40 kg wheat (1); Opportunity cost rises with more barley (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Scarcity arises from unlimited wants and limited resources (1); It forces choice (1); Each choice gives up an alternative (1); This sacrificed value is the opportunity cost (1); Example: sugarcane versus millets (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Opportunity cost is **not** the money spent or every alternative given up; it is the value of the **next best** alternative given up.
- Do not confuse *needs* and *wants*: food, water and shelter are needs; a designer watch or holiday trip is a want. Wants keep changing and growing.
- A PPC slopes **downward**. A point inside it means resources are under-used; a point outside it is not attainable with the given resources.

- Scarcity means limited resources compared with unlimited wants. It does not mean poverty, and it affects governments and firms as well as households.
- Match systems correctly: Cuba and North Korea are planned economies, the USA is a market economy, and India is a **mixed** economy.
- Do not mix up labour-intensive (handicrafts, traditional farming) with capital-intensive (steel, automobiles), or the three questions: what, how and for whom to produce.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **The Problem of Choice (Economics)** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** opportunity cost rises as more barley is produced	Increasing cost
2	**(a)** a problem of choice due to scarcity	Alternatives with limited funds
3	**(a)** Little motive to improve quality	Limited incentives
4	**(c)** a mixed economy	Both sectors
5	**(a)** opening to trade and reducing regulation	Liberalisation
6	**(a)** The air cooler	Forgone alternative
7	**(b)** environmental benefits given up	Water and soil health
8	**(a)** A student cannot study and play at the same time	Alternative uses
9	**(a)** reviews past performance and challenges	Blueprint for Budget
10	**(a)** are limited yet have alternative uses	Definition

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	By analysing data on tax and welfare (1); By advising on policy options and their costs (1).	1+1
12	Essentials come first (1); Savings protect against future needs (1).	1+1
13	Labour cost raises expenses (1); Machines reduce cost per unit (1).	1+1
14	Governments intervene even in markets (1); Private enterprise exists even under planning (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Reduce regulation (1); Encourage private enterprise (1); Open to global trade and competition (1).	1+1+1
16	To fulfil central targets (1); To control resources (1); To avoid private profit motive (1).	1+1+1
17	Each kg of barley costs 2 kg of wheat on this frontier (1); 20 kg barley would reduce wheat from 100 to 60 (1); Yes, it lies on the PPC (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Planned: central authority sets targets (1); Market: demand and supply guide producers (1); Result is government priorities versus consumer preferences (1).	1+1+1
18	Maintains law and order (1); Ensures safety and consumer protection (1); Provides public goods (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Income and taste differ (1); Leather for office-goers, rubber for sportspersons (1); Prevents wastage of resources (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Post-Independence planning with licences (1); Public sector dominated (1); 1991 difficulties (1); Reforms opened trade and competition (1); Government continues to provide public goods (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: What decides the product (1); How depends on the product and costs (1); For whom decides quality and price (1); All aim to use scarce resources best (1); Example: shoes for students, athletes, office-goers (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Before: licences and public sector (1); Controlled production and prices (1); After: reforms reduced regulation (1); Private firms and trade encouraged (1); Government continues to provide public goods (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Competition improves quality and lowers prices (1); Licences restrict entry (1); Planned control reduces innovation (1); Market needs rules (1); Mixed economy uses both (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

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SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** They are unlimited and shape demand	Wants grow
2	**(d)** Planned economy - Cuba	Cuba is state-controlled
3	**(d)** market orientation	Liberalisation
4	**(c)** the game she gave up	Next best alternative
5	**(c)** Street lighting in a city	Non-exclusive
6	**(b)** labour-intensive	Skilled labour
7	**(d)** opportunity cost of barley	Trade-off
8	**(b)** makes rules and provides public goods	Referee role
9	**(a)** Pure systems rarely exist and public goods are needed	Almost all economies are mixed
10	**(a)** A school has funds for either a lab or a playground, not both	Limited funds with alternative uses

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Restricted entry of private firms (1); Reduced competition and efficiency (1).	1+1
12	Wants rise with income and time (1); Resources like land and water are limited in quantity (1).	1+1
13	Designer goods need skilled labour (1); Mass-produced goods suit machines (1).	1+1
14	Resources like water are limited (1); It has an opportunity cost in soil health and water (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Show market trends (1); Reveal customer needs (1); Guide production and profit (1).	1+1+1
16	Funds are scarce (1); Each use has an opportunity cost (1); Decide by needs of students (1).	1+1+1
17	Costly machines favour labour (1); Cheap machines encourage automation (1); Firm picks the lower-cost mix (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Bread is bought by paying (1); Roads are available to all (1); Roads are public goods (1).	1+1+1
18	Spend on a want or keep as savings (1); Spend on something essential (1); Each choice gives up other uses (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Allows private initiative (1); Government still provides public goods (1); Balances growth and welfare (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Cost of machines versus labour (1); Technology available (1); Nature of product, custom or mass (1); Laws and regulations (1); Example: garments (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Pure planned systems lack incentives (1); Pure markets ignore public goods and equity (1); Governments regulate and provide welfare (1); Examples: India, Germany, even USA (1); Balance of both works best (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Needs are essentials, finite (1); Wants change as income rises (1); Scarcity results (1); Systems answer the three questions differently (1); Government regulates to ensure fairness (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Household divides income on food, medicine and savings (1); Government uses tax revenue for infrastructure and welfare (1); Both face scarcity (1); Both face opportunity cost (1); Government's choices affect many people (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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